

Coping With Copyright Cops

THIS ONE IS for everybody who has ever hit a record button. Stop! Digital media is so pervasive that the Big Boys are taking notice, and they do not like where your finger is headed.

In the era of digital culture, little bits of ideas and creations leap across routers and through computers around the world—bits with money behind them. Here, control is vital, since it defines the economy. Lawrence Lessig's *Free Culture* is a frightening ride through the history of copyright law, which was designed as a shield to the intellectual property of large conglomerates.

As absurd as the Digital Millennium Copyright Act (DMCA) seems to the silent majority that does not wish to steal money from its favourite artists, the law has precedence. It paves the way for the absurd Induce Act. Once passed, the Induce Act will criminalise the act of inducing another to commit a copyright violation. It's like putting you in jail because somebody used your hammer to break into



Author Lawrence Lessig

a house.

If you have ever listened to the radio, you should read this book. If you have ever recorded a song, you should read this book. If you have ever taped a favourite TV show or a vital cricket match, you should read this book. If you have thousands of songs sitting pretty on your computer while the original CDs gather dust in a remote cupboard, read this book. If you have ever felt thankful for the thousands before you who have inspired you with their music, moved

you with their words, teased you with their art, read this book. And if you do not care about a law nor are in the least bothered where society is headed, you should most definitely read this book.

Download a free copy from www.free-culture.org. Ah yes, check the copyrights for that as well!

Ahmed Shaikh

Free Culture: How Big Media Uses Technology And The Law To Lock Down Culture And Control Creativity

Publisher **The Penguin Press** Author **Lawrence Lessig**

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Web site www.free-culture.cc

Books

A Few Glitches Aside, This Lord Lords You Over



THIS TIME AROUND, you finally get to play as the Fellowship, with eleven characters available, out of which four can be unlocked.

The Return of the King starts by putting you in the role of Gandalf. No matter how casually you play the first level, you win the battle. It's the Skill Points that you are actually playing for.

There are four grades to attain—Fair,

Good, Excellent and Perfect. After the first level, you are given the choice of treading three different paths, just like in the movie. Ultimately, you have to take the Paths of the Dead.

All characters have excellent moves and combos. But you can't begin with outright combo action. Besides, the stylish combo moves need mastery. The great level design makes for some fun gameplay. But, the levels are arranged in order, difficulty-wise.

Overall, *ROTK* is a first-rate action game and is a must-buy. Once you beat the game, you get loads of bonuses, including DVD footage. There's a co-op mode for the PC version, where you can share your monitor with a friend. A few AI problems and an overfed camera are two hitches. Otherwise, *ROTK* lords you over.

SKOAR! Magazine

The Lord Of The Rings: The Return Of The King

Publisher **Electronic Arts** Developer **EA Pacific**

Web site www.eagames.com/official/lordoftherings/returnoftheking

System requirements **700 MHz CPU, 128 MB RAM, 32 MB video card, 2 GB free hard disk space**

The Simpsons' Show!

THE GAME, LIKE any typical Simpsons episode, is way beyond wacky. Mysterious bugs of alien origin have been released into the unsuspecting town of Springfield. It's now left to Homer to save the day.

Gameplay-wise, *Hit and Run* is very similar to the *GTA* series. You have a large area to explore and seek out hidden goodies. You can also seek out and destroy all the Rigelian bugs present in that level to earn your coins. As in *GTA*, you set your own pace for completing the missions.

H&R has its fair share of violence too. Then of course, there's the Simpsons brand of humour.

There are seven levels in the game, that give you 42 cars, 21 outfits, and 49 cards. But only a handful of cars are of any use. Also, walking across a narrow beam with a cumbersome camera view isn't exactly enjoyable, especially if you lack analogue sticks on the gamepad.

H&R isn't a game you can play at a stretch. But if you are a Simpsons fan, this game is worth killing for.

Courtesy SKOAR! Magazine

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TOP SELLING GAMES

- 1. Harry Potter: Prisoner Of Azkaban**
Rs 1,299
Gayatri Impex Pvt Ltd
- 2. Need For Speed: Underground**
Rs 1,299
Gayatri Impex Pvt Ltd
- 3. Driver 3**
Rs 2,999
Milestone Interactive Software
- 4. FIFA 2004**
Rs 1,299
Gayatri Impex Pvt Ltd
- 5. Jumpstart**
Rs 699
Express Interactive Software P Ltd

List Courtesy: Crossword Mumbai



The Simpsons: Hit & Run

Publisher **Vivendi Universal**

Developer **Radical Entertainment**

Web site www.hitandrungame.com

Price **Rs 999**

Distributor **Sony Music Entertainment**